



REVIVING CITIES

As cities run out of land, redevelopment of older neighbourhoods is emerging as a practical way to upgrade infrastructure, create new housing and breathe fresh life into old districts

BY E. JAYASHREE KURUP

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CITIES IN INDIA are being reshaped by the need for redevelopment. The challenge for urban planners, developers and policymakers is releasing land for modern precincts. A series of experiments is creating replicable models.

As urban land values soar, the middle- and lower-middle classes are being edged out of the city, to its peripheries. A NITI Aayog report on affordable housing in India has come up with a solution. “Ensure ways to defray the cost of land for affordable housing projects and improve the supply of serviced land.” This is often easier said than done.

UNDERUTILISED LAND

Navi Mumbai sought to unlock underutilised government land to create space for affordable housing across the heart of the city. Working with architect Hafeez Contractor, it set an ambitious target to deliver over 55 million sq ft of the Pradhan Mantri Awas Yojana (PMAY)-compatible housing in core city areas. Contractor’s proposal to the City and Industrial Development Corporation of Maharashtra (CIDCO) focused on identifying 24 under-utilised